

TIMELESS TRAILS

DINOSAUR FOOTPRINTS

Several thousand dinosaur footprints line the 328-ft (100-m) high walls of a limestone quarry in Cal Orcko, Bolivia. These prints were laid down by a range of different dinosaurs as they marched through the region's soft ground during the Late Cretaceous Period. Successive droughts and rainfalls helped to repeatedly dry and then cover these prints in mud, which fossilized and preserved them. Several million years later, movements in Earth's crust pushed the horizontal layers of rock upward and sideways, creating this near-vertical wall that has been informally called the "dinosaur dance floor."

Wall of prints

The prints on this wall were created around a prehistoric lake that attracted many herbivores who came to drink and feed, as well as the predators that hunted them. About 462 individual trackways have been traced across this $\frac{3}{4}$ -mile (1.2-km) long slab of rock, providing valuable information about dinosaur sizes from the distance between their prints. This also allows scientists to estimate the speed at which these creatures walked.

Theropod tracks cut across the long trail of sauropod footprints.

These sauropod tracks probably belonged to a titanosaur.